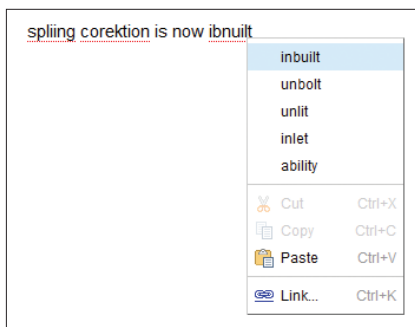




Now you don't have any excuses for messing up

EtherPad – and online document editor which provided real-time editing features such as those in the new Docs – with the intention of integrating them into the team working on Google Wave. It is clear that their talent has been put to good use.

or the replies they are sending to your messages in real time as they are being typed, character by character.

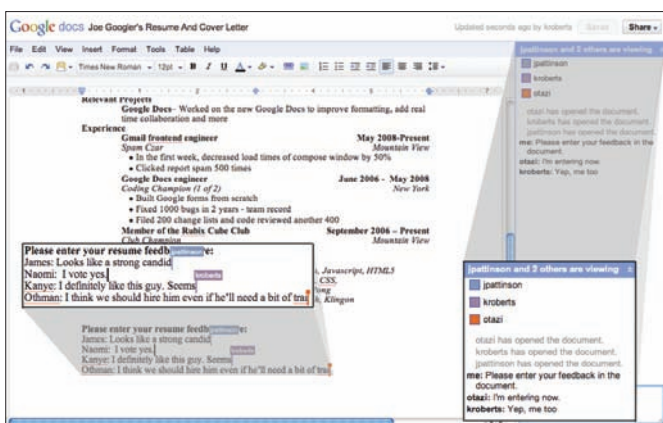
Now one can get exactly the same kind of feedback while using Google Docs, wherein you can see the changes others make racing across the screen trailed by their name highlighted in a unique color.

Commenting on documents in the new Google Docs is again much improved. Unlike in the earlier system where comments were inserted in-line into the document text, now comments are attached to text blocks and appear in floating boxes aside from the text. Another nice

Google Spreadsheets

Google Spreadsheets have had their own share of enhancements. For one, Google claims that they are much faster now, and working with large-sized spreadsheets should be a much better experience with smoother scrolling, and a more responsive interface.

Google Spreadsheets has seen a few more time-saving enhancements. Such as, the ability to drag-drop entire columns – something which was earlier only possible by multiple copy paste operations on columns – and auto-completion in spreadsheet cells. There have also been improvements to the



Online discussions by way of chat enhances your document

collaborative feature in Google Docs is that of an integrated chat panel which lets you converse with your fellow editors while working on a document.

Google had recently acquired a small company which created

way one can switch between sheets in Google Docs.

With the new version of spreadsheets, you can now edit the contents of a spreadsheet from the formula bar, much the same way you would in Excel.

While Google Docs spread sheets already had a chat panel for communicating while editing, and has better collaboration features that documents, now it has the same real-time features as those available for documents.

Images can be taken from googledocs.blogspot.com/2010/04/preview-faster-more-feature-rich-google.html

all other Google Docs tools it is sure to see its features improve over time

The Google Docs Drawing editor uses the SVG standard for drawing shapes and can export the content you create to SVG or to raster formats such as PNG and JPG.

Conclusion

Google Docs now also fea-



Google has also improved the commenting feature of Docs

Google Drawing

This is an entirely new addition to the Google Docs suite. Well, not entirely new. Google Docs earlier introduced a drawing feature for documents with which one could create diagram / drawings for including in a documents. Now they have introduced a stand-alone drawing tool which packs in more features.

As with the other Google Docs applications, collaboration is a big part of the new drawings editor, and chatting functionality is inbuilt into it as it is in the documents and spreadsheets editor.

The drawing editor packs quite a lot of tools and shapes to help you get started creating drawings fast. However it still lacks some important features such as creating connecting lines between drawings (such that they always move together), and while it can export to SVG, it doesn't seem to be able to import SVG documents. Of course this is just the beginning, and like

tures improved fidelity while importing document files, which is sure to ease transition for those still on the fence. With these new features you now now have a much more usable document creation experience online. No doubt this is because of Microsoft's upcoming online office suite, which is sure to tout better compatibility with their own formats. Although they too will not be offering the entire range of features available in their desktop suites – and understandably so.

These new features are now available to all for testing – yes testing, this is just a preview – and can be enabled through the Google Docs settings page. Unfortunately the new editor is only available for new documents, and your old documents will continue to use the older editor. Google plans to rectify this over time of course.

That isn't the only bad news, the new editor doesn't bring some of the features found in the older one. **d**